

Literature

General Lit.
Mythology/Hist. Fiction





About the Course

Overview note: Literature selections are chosen to encourage students to engage with rich ideas in literature and history and also to help them to gain independence in their reading and lessons.

This course includes the following topic(s): Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4, General Lit.: Grade 4

About General Lit.: Grade 4

Continue fostering independence and a love of reading with irresistible stories such as The Lion, the Witch, and the Wardrobe and historical fiction from the time period.

About Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4

Students read Norse mythology for a term, enjoy a term of fairy tales from around the world collected or written in the 19th century, and finish with a term of African American folktales.



Placement & Combining Tips

Literature: Grade 4

Overview note: Poetry lessons are an integral part of the whole Literature program, so look at both literature and poetry selections together when placing students.

General Lit.: Grade 4

Suitable for Grades 5-6 if combining.

Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4

Can easily be combined with students in Grades 3 or 5.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
4	General Lit.: Grade 4 1 time/week 20 min	The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates
4	Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 1 time/week 20 min	In the Days of Giants Russian Fairy Tales South American Jungle Tales The Tales of Uncle Remus: The Adventures of Brer Rabbit Short Stories & Folktales

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grade 4				
	General Lit.: Grade 4		Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4	



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

General Lit.: Grade 4

□ Although these books also make for great read-alouds, they were specifically chosen to help students to begin transitioning toward independence and continue growing in reading fluency and ease. While lesson plans are intended to be achievable during the lesson times on average, reading speed varies widely at this age. Focus on having students read for the time allotted, more than getting through the exact section assigned.

□ Ask students to recall what happened last before sending them to read the day's selection on their own. Oral narrations can be completed into a voice recorder or back with a parent or class. These are also great books to use for occasional written narrations.

Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4

In the Days of Giants tells the stories of Norse mythology and is read in Terms 1-2. The Nordic people would enjoy telling tales of heroes, gods, and monsters during the long, dark winter nights. As such, we recommend teachers preview the readings to ensure they are suitable for their particular students.

Term 2 (Folk Tales): Older Folk Tales often include content such as drinking, smoking, abuse of others, etc. The teacher should preview the tales if this might be an issue for your home or classroom.

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

General Lit.: Grade 4

□ If students have already read *The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe*, consider having them still read it on their own if it might help them gain confidence reading and completing lessons themselves. Otherwise, substitute another book in the Narnia series or substitute with a book from an adjacent grade's literature lessons and begin *Johnny Tremain* earlier in the year (the whole book is too long to finish before the end of Term 3, so it can easily be moved back).

□ For the *Silver Skates*, we have provided two different pacing options for the book depending on your student(s) and context. The first pacing option is slower and better suited for less confident readers reading independently OR those reading the book aloud with their student(s). Note that students will want to finish this book on their own time after the end of the year.

The second pacing option moves more quickly and allows students to finish the book. This is best suited to quick readers or those who want to assign any reading not finished in a lesson for students to complete as homework on their own time during the term.

Regardless of which pacing option you choose, be sure to leave time for students to narrate at the end of the lesson. Note that recap and discussion questions are based on the slower pacing so feel free to skip ahead and use a discussion question from a different lesson if you're following the faster option.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Literature: Grade 4

General Lit.: Grade 4



The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe



Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4



In the Days of Giants



Russian Fairy Tales



South American Jungle Tales



The Tales of Uncle Remus: The Adventures of Brer Rabbit

Short Stories & Folktales



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Literature: Grade 4

∞ [Extra Helpings](#)

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 9: Literature\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Literature: Grade 4

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance, especially for Shakespeare lessons. It is helpful to read the play or a preview of it beforehand.
- Choose which books to have students start reading independently (General Literature selections are especially good for independent work).



Recap

- Connect back to the previous lesson. Ask students to give a summary of what they remember and/or predict what might come next. (Full narration is not necessary.)
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them an illustration, sharing something that the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading and/or using a combination of visual and audio support this time) or repeating the last lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage aloud or have students read independently. For Shakespeare, it is highly recommended that each student have their own copy of the play and that you read it aloud together or read along and underline/make notes while listening to the audio recording.
- Use supportive strategies and educational tools to reduce frustration and better engage the mind, as appropriate. These could include, but are not limited to, the use of eBooks, pictures, audio, read-aloud, buddy reading, colored reading strips, etc.
- Some students may benefit from having a notebook or piece of scrap paper available to externalize ideas by drawing, recording names, or making symbolic 'squiggle' notes.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from: a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally or in writing. If writing, encourage students to use the full remaining lesson time and include as much detail as they can remember. For Shakespeare or challenging books, it may be helpful to narrate more frequently and/or use props.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas

in the manner most natural to them.

- Students who used paper or a notebook to externalize may refer to these for support. Other students who need external support may benefit from looking at a map or picture from the book while narrating.
- Students who tend to use the same type of narration all the time might be encouraged to try another form of narration by first doing it together through play or discussion.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill that requires coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today; notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they say about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note or take a break for the day, if necessary.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you can ask an open-ended question or use an included discussion question.

Literature: Grade 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 1

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ INTRO

Starting in Grades 3-4, more and more of our literature books will also relate to the historical time period we're studying in history courses. But some books are just beautiful and interesting stories to enjoy. Based on the title, do you have any guesses on what The Lion, the Witch, and the Wardrobe will be about?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1

WEEK 1 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 1

Materials: In the Days of Giants, Student World Atlas

→ INTRO

We will be reading Norse mythology. It is a series of beliefs and legends belonging to Scandinavian people who lived in modern-day Norway, Sweden, and Denmark. The Nordic people would enjoy telling tales of heroes, gods, and monsters during the long, dark winter nights.

→ LOCATE

Find Scandinavian countries of today: Denmark, Norway, Sweden

Map Resource: Student World Atlas

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"The Beginning of Things" and "How Odin Lost His Eye" p.9-16

WEEK 2 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 2

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ RECAP

What happened last?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2

WEEK 2 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 2

Materials: In the Days of Giants

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Kvasir's Blood" p.17-22

WEEK 3 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 3

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ RECAP

What happened last? Do you remember the names of the four children?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3

Literature: Grade 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 3 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 3

Materials: In the Days of Giants

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"The Giant Builder" p.23-28

WEEK 4 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 4

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ RECAP

What do you think will happen next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.4

WEEK 4 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 4

Materials: In the Days of Giants

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"The Magic Apples" p.29-38

★ TEACHER TIP

This chapter is longer. Students may finish in the afternoon or next lesson (which is shorter) if desired.

WEEK 5 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 5

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ INTRO

Which character do you relate to most so far?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5

WEEK 5 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 5

Materials: In the Days of Giants

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Skadi's Choice" p.39-42

WEEK 6 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 6

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ RECAP

What happened last?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.6

Literature: Grade 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 6 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 6

Materials: In the Days of Giants

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"The Dwarf's Gifts" p.43-51

WEEK 7 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 7

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ RECAP

Describe each of the four children.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7

WEEK 7 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 7

Materials: In the Days of Giants

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Loki's Children" p.52-56

WEEK 8 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 8

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ RECAP

What happened last?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.8

WEEK 8 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 8

Materials: In the Days of Giants

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"The Quest of the Hammer" p.57-66

★ TEACHER TIP

This chapter is longer. Students may finish in the afternoon or pick up next lesson.

WEEK 9 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 9

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ RECAP

Describe your favorite "supporting" character (i.e., not one of the main characters like Edmund, Aslan, etc.).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9

Literature: Grade 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 9 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 9

Materials: In the Days of Giants

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"The Giantess Who Would Not" p.67-72

WEEK 10 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 10

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ RECAP

What happened last?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.10

WEEK 10 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 10

Materials: In the Days of Giants

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Thor's Visit to the Giants" p.73-82

★ TEACHER TIP

This chapter is longer. Students may finish in the afternoon or over exam week if desired.

WEEK 11 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 11

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ RECAP

What do you think will happen next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.11

WEEK 11 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 11

Materials: In the Days of Giants

→ RECAP

What do you remember from this book from earlier this year?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Thor's Fishing" p.83-90

WEEK 12 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:

The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

Literature: Grade 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 12 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
In the Days of Giants

Literature: Grade 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 13

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ RECAP

What's currently happening in the story?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.12

WEEK 1 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 13

Materials: In the Days of Giants

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Thor's Duel" p.91-97

WEEK 2 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 14

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ RECAP

Who is your favorite character in the book now? Has it changed from a few months ago or stayed the same?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.13

WEEK 2 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 14

Materials: In the Days of Giants

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"In the Giant's House" p.98-105

WEEK 3 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 15

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ RECAP

Describe the White Witch.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.14

WEEK 3 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 15

Materials: In the Days of Giants

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Balder and the Mistletoe" p.106-113



Term 2

WEEK 4 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 16

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ RECAP

Describe Aslan.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.15

WEEK 4 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 16

Materials: In the Days of Giants

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"The Punishment of Loki" p.114-121

WEEK 5 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 17

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ RECAP

What happened last?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.16

WEEK 5 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 17

Materials: South American Jungle Tales

→ INTRO

For centuries, people shared stories out loud around fires, at celebrations, and before bed. By the 1800s, many people worried these beloved tales were disappearing as the world rapidly changed around them, so collectors began writing them down. The Brothers Grimm gathered folk tales across Germany, Hans Christian Andersen turned Danish traditions into fairy tales, and Andrew Lang collected stories from countries all over the world. In America, people began recording the stories of Indigenous communities and formerly enslaved people. Now it's your turn to explore these timeless tales and discover the stories people have treasured for generations. We'll start our journey in South America with a tale about a lazy bee.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"The Lazy Bee" Read from the beginning to "inside a hollow tree."

- What do you think will happen next?

→ MAP WORK

Find the continent of South America on a map or globe. Our first tale takes place in the country of Argentina. See if you can find Argentina on your map. (The story mentioned the city of Misiones. Misiones is actually not a city, but is one of the provinces of Argentina.)

★ TEACHER NOTE

The world of folk tales is vast. Explore extra helpings for other tales to include or substitute as desired. For instance, Favorite African Folk Tales by Nelson Mandela features many short tales that could easily be added to a lesson or enjoyed as a read-aloud.

Note that a Christmas tale is in the final two lessons of the term. Feel free to swap around the order of the tales if needed to read that story closer to Christmas.

Literature: Grade 4

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Term 2

WEEK 6 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 18

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ **RECAP, READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
Ch.17

- What did you think of the end of the story?

WEEK 6 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 18

Materials: South American Jungle Tales

→ **RECAP**
What happened to the little bee in the first part of the story?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
"The Lazy Bee" - Read "And now the little bee" to the end of the story.

→ **VIEW**
∞ Image Link: Sensitive Plant

- What was the lesson the little bee learned? Do you agree?

WEEK 7 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 19

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ **INTRO**
Following the Civil War, the American public was in dire need of a pleasant distraction. Hans Brinker offered this escape and became an instant bestseller, second only to Charles Dickens in sales. Mary Mapes Dodge made a lasting change in children's literature both as the author of Hans Brinker and editor of St. Nicholas magazine. She brought some of the finest writers of her day to young readers and helped make writing for children lively, thoughtful, and full of imagination.

This story is set in Holland. The Netherlands is the official name of the entire country, while Holland makes up two provinces within the country - North and South Holland. Optional: View Holland on this map. (Scroll down to see the map.)
∞ Map Link: The Netherlands

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
Ch.1-2
OR
Ch.1-3

- What have you already learned about Holland?

★ **TEACHER NOTE**
Choose which pacing option to follow based on the ability and interest of your student(s). See Planning & Prep notes for more details on each option.

• **TERMINOLOGY**
∞ **Article Link:** Hans Brinker Pronunciation & Corrections (shared with permission)

• **EXTRA HELPING**
Click "See More" near the top of this page to read a short bio of the author.
∞ **Article Link:** Mary Mapes Dodge Bio

WEEK 7 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 19

Materials: South American Jungle Tales

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
"The Giant Tortoise's Golden Rule"

- What was the moral or lesson in this story?

→ **MAPWORK**

Literature: Grade 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

Our last tale took place in the South American country of Argentina. This tale includes a man from Buenos Aires, which is the capital city of Argentina. See if you can find Buenos Aires on a map.

WEEK 8 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 20

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ MAP WORK

Use your atlas or view this map and find Amsterdam, the capital city of the Netherlands. You may want to print the map and tuck it in the book to refer to as you read.

∞ Map Link: Netherlands Map

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3-4

OR

Ch.4-6

- How would you describe Hans and Gretel to a friend?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: Dutch Windmill Inside

WEEK 8 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 20

Materials: Russian Fairy Tales

→ INTRO

Our next tales come from Russia. Russia is a vast land with a rich culture full of art, music, poetry, and storytelling stretching back hundreds of years. Its folk tales offer a window into a culture that loved nature, prized humility, and understood that life held both joy and hardship. Heroes in these stories are often humble and kind rather than powerful and proud, and magic is woven naturally into the everyday world. As you read, remember that you are not just enjoying a good story, but catching a glimpse of a way of life.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Tsar Sultan: Read from the beginning to "written in a tale."

- Does this fairy tale remind you of any others you have heard?

→ MAPWORK

Find Russia on a map. The land occupied by Russia has changed over many years. In the 1800's, Russia even owned the land that is now the state of Alaska. Russia sold Alaska to the United States in 1867, though it didn't become a state until almost 100 years later, in 1959.

WEEK 9 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 21

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

How did Hans and Gretel find a friend?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5-7

OR

Ch.7-9

- What "shadows" hang over the Brinker home?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: Traditional Dutch Winter Skating

Literature: Grade 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 9 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 21

Materials: Russian Fairy Tales

→ RECAP

What has happened to the Tsaritsa and her son so far?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Tsar Sultan: Read "They entered it" to the end of the tale.

- What part of the tale was most surprising to you? Most interesting? Why?

• EXTRA HELPINGS

The George MacDonald Christmas Collection is a good choice if you'd like to substitute a tale during the Christmas season.

∞ Link: George MacDonald Christmas Collection

WEEK 10 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 22

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What do you remember about Hans and Gretel's parents?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.8-9

OR

Ch.10-11

- What does the boys' plan to skate nearly fifty miles reveal about them and the time they live in?

→ VIEW

St. Nicholas illustration from St. Nicholas magazine, where Mary Mapes Dodge served as editor.

∞ Image Link: St. Nicholas Illustration

• LITERATURE CONNECTION

Louisa May Alcott (of Little Women fame) wrote for the St. Nicholas magazine!

WEEK 10 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 22

Materials: "Papa's Christmas Story" (aka A Scot's Christmas Story) by George MacDonald

→ INTRO

George MacDonald was a Scottish storyteller (1823-1905). He loved fairy tales and fantasy, and even inspired C.S. Lewis, who wrote The Chronicles of Narnia! MacDonald was a devoted Christian, and his faith showed in his writing. He loved Christmas so much that he would carol through the streets with his children and sometimes invite over a hundred strangers into his home to celebrate! He wrote Christmas poems, songs, and stories to share that joy with others. Today you're going to read one of his Christmas stories called "Papa's Story" (sometimes called "A Scot's Christmas"). In it, a father tells his children a tale on Christmas Eve. As you read, think about what lessons might be hiding inside, just like the other tales we have read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Papa's Christmas Story" (aka A Scot's Christmas Story) by George MacDonald

p.40-48 til "He soon fell asleep."

∞ Link: "Papa's Christmas Story"

- What do you think Nelly has made up her mind to do?

→ MAPWORK (OPTIONAL)

This tale takes place in Scotland. Find Scotland on a map or globe.

★ TEACHER NOTE

This story can be borrowed on Internet Archive and is also available in this book under the title "Papa's Story."

∞ Link: George MacDonald Christmas Collection

There is a mention of drinking alcohol in the assigned reading.

Literature: Grade 4

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Term 2

WEEK 11 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 23

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What do you think will happen next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.10-11

OR

Ch.12-15

- How do Dutch customs of the Saint Nicholas celebration compare to your own Christmas celebrations?

• EXTRA HELPING

Virtually browse some of the art mentioned in this chapter if time allows.

∞ Link: Rijksmuseum Art

WEEK 11 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 23

Materials: "Papa's Christmas Story" (aka A Scot's Christmas Story) by George MacDonald

→ RECAP

What did Nelly dream about?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.48 "When Nelly thought" - p.60 (end of story)

- Did this story remind you of a Bible story you have heard before? If so, how are they alike and different?
- Why do you think MacDonald chose to tell this kind of story at Christmas? What does it have to do with the meaning of the holiday?

→ MAPWORK

Nelly traveled to Edinburgh, which is the capital city of Scotland. See if you can find Edinburgh on a map.

WEEK 12 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

WEEK 12 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:

Folk Tales from lessons

Literature: Grade 4

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Term 3

WEEK 1 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 25

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the Saint Nicholas celebrations?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.12-13

OR

Ch.16-18

→ MAP WORK

Use your atlas or view this map and find Haarlem.

∞ Map Link: Netherlands Map

- How would you have responded to the "catastrophe" if you had been with the boys?

WEEK 1 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 25

Materials: Tales of Uncle Remus

PREP: For history and context on this collection of Brer Rabbit tales and their broader relevance, read Julius Lester's Foreword on p.xiii-xxi.

→ INTRO

Many different stories were published and told in the 1700s. Some stories that became increasingly popular were about a rabbit. A rabbit is the main character in many folktales from Africa, and as more and more people in Africa were enslaved and brought to the American colonies, "...they took stories from home about a hare – Wakaima – and adapted them to their new surroundings" (viii). Over time, a new set of stories developed about a rabbit, now named Brer Rabbit, through this interaction of cultures from Africa, America, and the West Indies. The stories were told aloud and changed depending on the storyteller and the listener, so while they are old stories, they are also new every time they are told.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.4-10 "How Brer Fox and Brer Dog Became Enemies," "Hold'im Down, Brer Fox," "Brer Rabbit Comes to Dinner"

★ TEACHER NOTE

There is an audiobook version of these tales read by the author, which is a great option to give students a bit more independence and allow them to experience the stories orally. Note that only selections of the book are included in the lesson plans. Some of the omitted stories have content you might want to preview before allowing students to listen to the whole book.

WEEK 2 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 26

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What happened in the catastrophe? What do you think will happen next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.14-15

OR

Ch.19-21

- What different kinds of homes are described?
- Why does Gretel struggle with her feelings about her father?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: Historic Dutch Home Tour

Literature: Grade 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 2 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 26

Materials: Tales of Uncle Remus

→ INTRO

Who would you expect to win a contest or a fight between a rabbit and a fox?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.16-23 "Brer Rabbit Gets Even"

WEEK 3 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 27

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the Brinker home?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.16-17

OR

Ch.22-23

- Why do you think the author includes so many details about the places the boys visit?

WEEK 3 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 27

Materials: Tales of Uncle Remus

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.26-31 "Brer Turtle, Brer Rabbit, and Brer Fox" and "Brer Wolf Tries to Catch Brer Rabbit"

- Were you worried Brer Rabbit might not get away this time?

WEEK 4 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 28

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What was the meaning of the "man with four heads"?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.18-19

OR

Ch.24-26

- What dangers or freedoms come with spending so much time on the ice?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: Can a Finger Really be Used to Stop a Leaky Dike?

WEEK 4 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 28

Materials: Tales of Uncle Remus and painting/drawing supplies

→ INTRO

If you have heard it before, tell what you remember about the story of the turtle racing the hare. Today's story is a different version of it!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.31-34 "Brer Rabbit Finally Gets Beaten"

- What did you think of the story?

Literature: Grade 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

- How was Brer Turtle the perfect match for Brer Rabbit?

→ ILLUSTRATE

Draw or paint an illustration to go with today's story!

WEEK 5 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 29

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What happened last on the canal?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.20-21

OR

Ch.27-28

- How do group plans reveal who is flexible, selfish, cautious, or brave?

★ TEACHER NOTE

The next lesson includes an optional video for traditional Dutch gingerbread (a five-ingredient quick bread). Look ahead and gather ingredients if you would like to make your own.

WEEK 5 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 29

Materials: Tales of Uncle Remus

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.42-43 "Brer Fox and Brer Rabbit Go Hunting"

p.46-50 "Brer Rabbit Eats the Butter"

- What do you think Brer Fox meant when he said he "caught a handful of common sense"?
- What do you think about the ending of the story with Brer Rabbit and the butter? Did it surprise you? If you made up a different ending for the story, what would it be?

WEEK 6 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 30

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the Red Lion so far?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.22-23

OR

Ch.29-32

- How does the author mix comedy and danger? Why do you think she chose to do that?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

With the remaining time or in the afternoon, learn how to make traditional Dutch gingerbread.

∞ Video Link: Traditional Dutch Gingerbread

WEEK 6 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 30

Materials: Tales of Uncle Remus

→ INTRO

What do you think it means if I say someone is "resourceful"?

→ READ

p.54-56 "Brer Rabbit's Children"

p.60-62 "Brer Rabbit and Brer Lion"

Literature: Grade 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Since these readings are shorter, practice giving as much detail as possible in your written or oral narrations. Tell/write the stories as if you were telling them to a friend who had never heard them before!

WEEK 7 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 31

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

How did the Red Lion become dangerous? What was the resolution?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.24-25

OR

Ch.33-36

→ MAP WORK

Use your atlas or view this map and find Leiden (Leyden is an older spelling).

∞ Map Link: Netherlands Map

- How can visiting museums help us better understand the people, history, and culture of a place?

• EXTRA HELPING

The "Egyptian Museum" is likely the Rijksmuseum van Oudheden.

∞ Link: Rijksmuseum van Oudheden

WEEK 7 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 31

Materials: Tales of Uncle Remus

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.68-71 "The Talking House" and "Brer Rabbit Gets Eaten Again"

p.96-99 "The Moon in the Pond"

- Have you ever seen the moon in a pond or a puddle?

→ ILLUSTRATE

With the remaining time, illustrate a scene from one of today's stories.

WEEK 8 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 32

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What did the boys see in Leyden?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.26-27

OR

Ch.37-40

- How does the quote "it is no sin to love beautiful things if you adapt your material to circumstances" help us think about enjoying beauty wisely?

WEEK 8 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 32

Materials: Tales of Uncle Remus

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.99-101 "Why Brer Bear Has No Tail"

p.104-106 "Brer Rabbit Gets the Money"

Literature: Grade 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

- If you made up a Brer Rabbit story, what would it be about? Maybe try making one up this week!

WEEK 9 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 33

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What stories were shared in the last lesson?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.28-29

OR

Ch.41-42

→ MAP WORK

Use your atlas or view this map and find The Hague.

∞ Map Link: Netherlands Map

- Why is a day of rest important in the story?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: The Hague Market Today

WEEK 9 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 33

Materials: Tales of Uncle Remus

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.113-115 "The Noise in the Woods"

p.122-124 "Brer Rabbit Tells on Brer Wolf"

- What things do you admire or like about Brer Rabbit? What things do you think he does that are wrong?

WEEK 10 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 34

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What happened during the visit to The Hague?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.30-31

OR

Ch.43-44

- As they head home, what has changed because of their journey?

WEEK 10 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 34

Materials: Tales of Uncle Remus

→ INTRO

One of our stories today is called "How Brer Rabbit Became a Scary Monster." What do you think is going to happen?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.127-131 "How Brer Rabbit Became a Scary Monster"

p.137-141 "Brer Rabbit Outwits Mr. Man"

Literature: Grade 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 11 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 35

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What happened as the boys headed home?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.32-33

OR

Ch.45-48

- Why is it sometimes difficult to hope when a situation feels uncertain?
- How can friendship help someone going through tough times?

WEEK 11 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 35

Catch Up

Materials: Tales of Uncle Remus

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 12 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ READ & DISCUSS

Ch.34-35

OR

Finish the book over exam week as needed.

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Article Link: Elfstedentocht:
The Famed Frozen Race

WEEK 12 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

The Tales of Uncle Remus

Literature: Grade 4

Examination

Term 1

Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4

- In the Days of Giants: Give a short account of one of Odin's or Loki's adventures using words or pictures.

General Lit.: Grade 4

- The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe: Who is your favorite character in the book? Why?

Term 2

Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4

- Tell about a favorite fairy or folk tale you read this term and what lesson or moral the tale was trying to share.

- Why do tales from different countries and cultures have things in common with each other? Give some examples of similar tales.

General Lit.: Grade 4

- The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe: What did you think of the end of the book?

Term 3

Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4

- Tales of Uncle Remus: Tell the story of Brer Rabbit and Brer Turtle OR tell a story about Brer Rabbit and Brer Fox.

General Lit.: Grade 4

- Hans Brinker: Explain two ways that Hans and Gretel show responsibility and care for their family. What do their actions tell us about the kind of people they are? OR Describe two places the boys visit during their trip and explain what they see or experience at each one.